GyanSetu

ज्ञान सेतु

A Bridge to Every Student's Future

The startup that answers the question every Indian family is afraid to ask out loud:

"Beta, aage kya karoge?"

Startup Vision & Product Blueprint | 2026

CONFIDENTIAL — For Investors, Advisors & Core Team

PART ONE — THE PROBLEM

The Night Before the Results

Picture a home somewhere in Bhopal. Or Patna. Or Coimbatore. It doesn't matter — this scene plays out in millions of homes across India every single year.

It's 11 PM. A Class 12 student is sitting at their desk, staring at the ceiling. Tomorrow, board results come out. Three years ago, their parents enrolled them in a Science stream because a neighbour's son got into IIT and everyone said "Science is the safe option." Nobody asked this student whether they actually liked Biology. Nobody sat them down and said: here are all the doors this stream opens for you. Here is what it actually takes to walk through each one. Here is how long it will take. Here is what life looks like on the other side.

Tomorrow, the score will arrive. And the family will gather around a phone or a TV, and someone will say: "70% marks aaye hain — ab kya karein?"

And nobody — not the school, not the coaching centre, not Google, not any app on their phone — will have a real answer.

> *"I had good marks. But I had no idea what I was good for. My parents told me to take whatever my cousin took. I spent two years preparing for an exam I didn't understand, for a career I'd never actually thought about."*
>
> **— Real words from a UPSC aspirant, Lucknow, 2024**

This Is Not One Family's Problem

Over 1.5 crore students appear for Class 12 boards every year in India. Of those, a significant number — studies suggest anywhere from 40 to 60 percent — report feeling confused or directionless about their career choices at the time of passing. That number isn't a statistic. That's real confusion. Real anxiety. Real years lost.

We have coaching centres for almost everything — JEE, NEET, UPSC, Banking, CAT. But not one of them helps a student answer the question that comes before all of that: which exam should I even be preparing for? And why? And what happens to my life if I choose it?

Here's what makes this problem so painful: the answers exist. The information is out there — in government notifications, in college websites, in salary surveys, in exam syllabi. But it is scattered, jargon-heavy, inaccessible, and completely un-personalised. A student sitting in a Tier-3 city with 60% marks in Commerce, belonging to OBC category, with only 2 years before they age out of certain government jobs — that student has a very specific set of opportunities available to them. But nobody has ever mapped those opportunities out for them. Nobody has ever said: this is your exact landscape. These are your paths. This is what each one costs you in time and effort. This is where each one takes you.

That is the problem GyanSetu was built to solve.

PART TWO — THE IDEA

What If Someone Just Told You the Truth?

GyanSetu started from a simple, almost stubborn conviction: every student in India deserves the same quality of career guidance that only rich families can currently afford. The kind of guidance where someone actually sits with you, looks at your situation — your marks, your category, your state, your age, your stream — and says: here is what is possible for you. Honestly. Completely. Without judgment.

That is GyanSetu. Not an app that shows you a list of careers. Not a chatbot that gives you generic advice. A personalised career intelligence platform that knows your exact situation and maps every single path available to you — from the ones you can start tomorrow to the ones that require two years of bridge learning — all the way to a realistic picture of what your income, lifestyle, and opportunities will look like at the end.

Imagine this: Priya, 18, just passed Class 12 with PCM (Physics, Chemistry, Mathematics). She scored 68%. She belongs to OBC category. She's in Nagpur. She always wanted to be a doctor, but her school told her she needed PCB for NEET, not PCM.

She opens GyanSetu. Enters her details. Within seconds, the platform tells her:

"You cannot attempt NEET directly — it requires Biology. But here is exactly what you need to do if medicine is truly your calling: spend 8-12 months studying Biology (Class 11 & 12), then register for NEET. Your OBC category gives you 5 attempts and an extended age limit. Here is a realistic timeline: 12 months prep + 4.5 years MBBS + 1 year internship = you are a practising doctor in 6.5 years at age 24-25. Expected starting salary in a government hospital: ₹70,000–₹90,000 per month. Private practice potential within 5 years: ₹2,00,000+ per month."

But it doesn't stop there. The same screen also shows her: Government jobs she is eligible for RIGHT NOW with her current PCM background. Engineering entrance options. Banking exams she can appear for. Each with the same clarity — time, effort, income, growth.

For the first time in her life, Priya isn't choosing blindly. She is choosing with her eyes open.

The Visual We Dream Of

In the early days of planning GyanSetu, the founding team kept coming back to one image: the difference in how a student sees their future before and after using this platform.

Before GyanSetu, a student looks ahead and sees one narrow road disappearing into fog. No signs. No distances marked. No idea where it leads or when it ends.

After GyanSetu, that same student looks out and sees a landscape — multiple roads stretching in every direction, each one clearly labelled, each one lit up with time estimates and destinations, all of them real, all of them within reach if they know what to do next. And critically — each road is colour-coded by how hard the switch is. Not to scare them. To help them choose honestly.

This is not inspiration-poster thinking. This is what GyanSetu actually builds, screen by screen.

PART THREE — THE PLATFORM

Module 1: The Career Engine — "What Can I Do?"

The first thing a student does on GyanSetu is fill in what we call their Life Profile. Not a complicated form — a five-minute conversation-style intake that captures:

- Their highest qualification and stream (Class 10, 12 PCB/PCM/Commerce/Arts, Graduation, Diploma, etc.)
- Their age — because age-based eligibility rules are surprisingly complex in Indian government exams
- Their category (General, SC, ST, OBC, EWS) — which significantly changes attempt limits and cutoffs
- Their state — because state-specific exams like MPSC, TNPSC, and KPSC require domicile
- Their remaining attempts for exams they're already chasing
- Their subjects studied — the foundational data for the path-switching engine

Every Eligible Exam — Instantly

The moment the profile is complete, GyanSetu maps it against a live database of every major Indian competitive exam — National, State, Banking, Defense, Teaching, Law, Medical, Engineering — and surfaces every single exam this student is eligible for, right now, today.

Not a generic list. Not "you might want to look at IAS." A precise, filtered, personalised map. With the difficulty of each exam rated honestly. With how many students competed for each seat last year. With which category gives you how many extra attempts.

The Path-Switching Engine — Possibly Our Most Important Feature

Here is the scenario that breaks the most hearts in India: a student who has spent three years on one path, realises it isn't right for them, and has no idea if they can switch — and at what cost.

The Maths student who wants to be a doctor. The Arts student who suddenly wants to crack SSC CGL. The Engineering graduate who wants to become a lawyer. Every one of these is

possible. But nobody has ever told these students exactly how much bridge learning they need, how long it will actually take, and whether it's worth it given their age and situation.

GyanSetu's path-switching engine does exactly this. You enter your current qualification. You pick any target career. The platform tells you:

- What specific qualifications or subject knowledge you are missing
- How long it realistically takes to acquire them — with conservative and optimistic estimates
- Whether your age and remaining attempts make this path feasible
- A difficulty rating — not to discourage, but to prepare

Real example: Rahul, 22, B.Com graduate, Jaipur. He always wanted to be an IPS officer but spent three years doing his commerce degree under family pressure.

He opens GyanSetu and selects UPSC Civil Services as his target.

GyanSetu's path-switching engine responds:
"Your B.Com degree makes you fully eligible for UPSC. You have used 0 of your 6 General category attempts (you are under 32). No additional qualification needed — you can register for next year's Prelims. The gap: you have never studied Geography, History, Polity, or Science for UPSC. Estimated preparation time from zero: 14-18 months for a credible first attempt."

It then shows him a complete timeline — month by month. And income projections for an IPS officer at every rank, based on the 7th Pay Commission, updated to 2025 figures.

Rahul's first reaction: "I spent 3 years thinking this was impossible. It took GyanSetu 30 seconds to show me it isn't."

The Income & Life Timeline Projector

This feature answers the question every parent asks but students rarely think through: "Isme kitna scope hai?"

For every career path, GyanSetu builds a detailed, realistic financial and life timeline. Not aspirational numbers pulled from nowhere. Numbers grounded in government pay commission data, NIRF placement records, industry salary surveys, and historical growth rates.

Take MBBS as an example. The timeline GyanSetu shows isn't just "6.5 years then you're a doctor." It breaks down:

- Year 0–1: NEET preparation. Cost estimate: ₹40,000–₹2,50,000 depending on coaching
- Year 1–5.5: MBBS at a Government Medical College. Stipend during internship: ~₹25,000/month
- Year 5.5: First salary as a MBBS doctor (House Job): ₹40,000–₹65,000/month
- Year 7–10: With MD/MS specialisation, expected income: ₹1,20,000–₹2,50,000+/month

- Year 10+ private practice potential — projected using historical clinic revenue data

And it shows all of this alongside two or three alternative paths — so the student can compare NEET against, say, B.Pharma + MBA, or Allied Health Sciences — not to push them anywhere, but to give them the full picture they deserve.

For the Students Who "Failed" — The Second Chances Engine

Here is a group that nobody talks about loudly enough: the students whose attempts are over. The 28-year-old who gave UPSC five times. The 25-year-old who tried JEE twice and got into a decent college but not IIT. The student who wanted government banking jobs but aged out.

These students are not failures. They have years of discipline, domain knowledge, and preparation behind them. GyanSetu treats them with the respect that deserves.

The Second Chances Engine takes their existing knowledge — mapped against the subjects they've studied and the exams they've attempted — and surfaces every other path that can be reached from where they already are. With minimal additional learning. With honest timelines. With real income projections.

A UPSC aspirant who knows General Studies inside out has expertise that is directly valuable in: State PCS exams, SET/NET (teaching), Policy research roles, Civil Services coaching (the economy of coaching aspirants is enormous), Content writing and editorial roles in news and policy media.

GyanSetu doesn't let any student feel like the road has ended. It finds the next road.

Module 2: The Roadmap — "How Do I Get There?"

Choosing a path is only the first step. The harder question — the one that kills momentum for most students — is: okay, I've decided. Now what do I actually study? In what order? From which book? How much of it matters for the exam?

GyanSetu's Roadmap Builder answers all of this. But the way it does it is fundamentally different from anything available today.

Not a Syllabus. A Living, Personalised Plan.

Every teacher will tell you: "Study the NCERT, do the PYQs, revise." That advice is technically correct and practically useless. Because a student with 4 months before their exam has completely different needs than a student with 18 months. A student who already knows Organic Chemistry has completely different needs than one starting from scratch.

When a student sets up their GyanSetu roadmap, they answer three questions: How much time do I have? How many hours a day can I realistically study? What do I already know?

The platform then builds a roadmap that is theirs and only theirs. The topics that carry the highest exam weightage come first. The topics they've already marked as known get deprioritised. The time is allocated intelligently — more hours to high-difficulty, high-weightage topics; lighter treatment for low-stakes areas.

And it goes deep. Not just "Chapter 3 — Cell Structure." But:

- Chapter 3 > Cell Structure > Prokaryotic vs Eukaryotic Cells > Sub-topic: Differences table (NEET direct question source)
- Chapter 3 > Cell Structure > Cell Organelles > Sub-topic: Ribosome function (appears in NEET 7 times since 2015)
- Chapter 3 > Cell Structure > Boxed content: Nobel Prize for Cell Biology — must know for NEET (appears as trivia question)

Nothing is missed. Not the boxes. Not the diagrams. Not the footnotes. Because for NEET, for UPSC, for Law — the exact line from the exact source is often the exam question.

Free and Premium Resources — Clearly Labelled

GyanSetu doesn't assume every student can afford Unacademy or PW subscriptions. For every single topic on the roadmap, the platform provides both: the best free resource available (specific YouTube videos, free PDFs, government websites) and the best premium resource if the student has access.

Clearly labelled. No pressure either way. Because the goal is the student's success — not a platform's revenue.

Progress That Actually Means Something

As students check off topics, the roadmap updates in real time. But GyanSetu doesn't just show "35% complete" — a number that can feel both exciting and meaningless. It shows:

- Which high-priority topics are still pending — so students know where the real risk is
- How many days they are ahead of or behind their own plan — so they can recalibrate without panic
- A weak-area heatmap — updated dynamically based on both roadmap completion and quiz performance

Preparation is a marathon that most students run without a watch or a distance marker. GyanSetu gives them both.

Module 3: The AI Tutor — "I Don't Understand This"

Every student who has ever prepared for a competitive exam alone knows this exact moment: it's late at night, you're on page 218 of NCERT Biology, you hit a paragraph about enzyme inhibition, and you simply don't get it. Your teacher isn't available. The YouTube video on this topic is 47 minutes long. The coaching notes are even more confusing than the textbook.

You give up for the night. You mark it as "will come back to this." You probably never do.

GyanSetu's AI tutor is built for exactly this moment.

Why This Is Not ChatGPT

The first thing students say when they hear "AI chatbot for studies" is: "Why can't I just use ChatGPT?" It's a fair question. And the honest answer is this:

ChatGPT is a brilliant, general-purpose conversationalist. It can explain enzyme inhibition. But if you're preparing for NEET 2026, you don't just need an explanation — you need the explanation that matches the exact language and framing of your NCERT Class 12 Biology textbook, because that is what the exam tests. You need the exact line on page 160. You need to know that this concept appeared in NEET 2019 as a direct question. And you need ChatGPT to not accidentally mix in information from university-level Biochemistry that will confuse rather than help you.

ChatGPT cannot do any of that. GyanSetu's tutor can.

A student asks GyanSetu: "What is competitive inhibition?"

GyanSetu responds:

SIMPLE EXPLANATION: In competitive inhibition, a molecule that looks similar to the enzyme's normal substrate sneaks into the active site and blocks it — like someone sitting in a reserved seat that isn't theirs. The enzyme can't do its job until the fake molecule leaves.

FROM YOUR NCERT (Class 12, Biology, Chapter 8 — Metabolism, Page 160):
"In competitive inhibition, the inhibitor competes with the substrate for the active site of the enzyme..."

THIS APPEARED IN NEET: → 2019 Paper (Q. 47), 2021 Paper (Q. 31) — both as direct definition questions.

RELATED PYQS: [Sidebar shows 3 actual NEET questions on this topic with options and correct answers — playable right there]

Subject Lock — Because Focus Matters

Here is a design decision that might seem small but makes an enormous difference in practice: GyanSetu's AI tutor can be locked to a specific subject and class before a student begins asking questions.

If a student is in "Class 12 Biology — NEET mode," the tutor will only answer from Class 12 Biology NCERT. It will not drift into Class 11 material, Physics, Chemistry, or anything else. It will not give advanced university-level answers that could confuse a student who only needs the Board-and-NEET-level understanding.

This is not a limitation. This is protection. One of the biggest sources of confusion and anxiety in competitive exam preparation is accidentally going too deep in areas that don't need deep treatment. GyanSetu helps students use their study time wisely, not just extensively.

The PYQ Sidebar — A Habit-Forming Feature

The moment any question is typed into GyanSetu's tutor, the platform simultaneously searches its database of Previous Year Questions and populates a sidebar with every PYQ that is directly relevant to the topic being asked about. Each card shows the exam, the year, the full question with options, and the correct answer.

The genius of this feature is not the technology — it's the behaviour it creates. Students who use GyanSetu stop treating doubts as problems to solve and start treating them as practice opportunities. Every "I don't understand this" becomes a five-minute session that ends with: I understand the concept, I've seen the NCERT line, and I've just attempted the real exam questions on it.

That shift — from passive doubt to active practice — is one of the most powerful changes in study behaviour we can create.

Module 4: Practice & Progress — "Am I Actually Ready?"

Knowing a concept and being able to answer an exam question about it under pressure are two entirely different skills. GyanSetu's practice engine is built around one goal: closing that gap, as efficiently as possible.

The PYQ Bank

Decades of past exam questions, meticulously tagged — by exam, by year, by subject, by chapter, by topic, by difficulty. A student preparing for NEET can filter to see every question ever asked from Chapter 8 of Class 12 Biology. A student who marked five questions as "Important" during doubt-solving sessions with the chatbot can find them all in one place and attempt them in a focused session.

Every question comes with a detailed solution. Every solution links back to the relevant NCERT source. The circle closes.

The Dashboard — A Mirror, Not a Report Card

Most dashboards in study apps show you what you've done. GyanSetu's dashboard is designed to show you what it means.

It doesn't just say "you've completed 45% of the syllabus." It says: you've completed 45% of the syllabus, but 80% of your weak areas are in high-weightage chapters. Here are the three chapters that, if you master them in the next two weeks, will have the highest impact on your mock test score.

It doesn't just log your study hours. It shows you your consistency score — because showing up every day for 2 hours beats cramming 14 hours on a Sunday, and the data proves it.

It doesn't just show your quiz accuracy. It ranks your topics by accuracy so you always know exactly where your time is best spent today.

PART FOUR — WHY GYANSETU WINS

The Honest Comparison

We're not building this in a vacuum. There are smart people at Unacademy, at Physics Wallah, at BYJU's, at Shiksha — and there are extremely capable AI tools like ChatGPT. We respect every one of them. But none of them are solving the same problem we are. Here is the honest breakdown:

What a student needs	GyanSetu	ChatGPT / AI	Coaching Apps
"Which exams am I eligible for?"	✅ **Personalised scan**	❌ Generic answers	❌ One exam only
"Can I switch to this career?"	✅ **Full switch analysis**	❌ Not possible	❌ Not possible
"How long will it take?"	✅ **Data-backed timeline**	⚠️ Rough estimates	❌ Not answered
"What will I earn?"	✅ **Projected income**	⚠️ Vague figures	❌ Not answered
Personalised roadmap for my time & knowledge	✅ **Fully adaptive**	❌ Not possible	⚠️ Rigid syllabus
NCERT answer with exact page citation	✅ **Yes — exact line**	❌ May hallucinate	❌ No
PYQs triggered automatically on doubt	✅ **Instant sidebar**	❌ Not possible	⚠️ Separate section
Guidance when attempts are exhausted	✅ **Second Chances Engine**	❌ No	❌ No
Everything in one platform	✅ **Fully integrated**	❌ Chat only	❌ Fragmented

The Deeper Point

Coaching apps teach you how to study. ChatGPT answers your questions. GyanSetu tells you who you are, where you can go, how to get there, and what it will feel like when you arrive. These are fundamentally different offerings. We're not competing with coaching platforms — we're the layer that sits above them and tells students which one to even use.

PART FIVE — THE BUSINESS

Who We Serve and How We Grow

The Market — It's Not Small

India has approximately 260 million students enrolled in secondary and higher education. Every single one of them faces the career guidance problem. The Indian edtech market was valued at over $7 billion in 2023 and is growing at roughly 16% annually. But the career guidance and academic counselling segment within it remains largely fragmented and underserved — dominated by expensive one-on-one consultants accessible only to upper-middle-class urban families, and generic online portals that provide information without intelligence.

GyanSetu's target audience is not the IIT aspirant from South Delhi who has a father who's an engineer and a mother who's been researching his college options since Class 8. GyanSetu is for the student from Raipur whose parents are asking a neighbour for career advice. The student in Siliguri who doesn't know there are government jobs she's eligible for right now. The student in Agra who tried UPSC twice and thinks his life is over at 27.

These students are not a niche. They are the majority.

Free vs. Premium — Built for Accessibility First

GyanSetu's free tier is genuinely useful — not artificially crippled. A student with no money can get their eligibility scan, see their top paths, get started on their roadmap, ask the AI tutor up to 20 questions a day, and attempt daily PYQ practice. We believe that the student who can least afford to pay us is often the one who needs us most. We don't want money to be the barrier between a student and their future.

GyanSetu Pro removes all limits and adds the full depth: unlimited career analyses, complete adaptive roadmaps, unlimited AI tutoring, full PYQ database access, advanced analytics, and priority access to every new feature. Priced to be accessible to a middle-class Indian family — not at Unacademy subscription rates.

Revenue Beyond Subscriptions

Institutional licensing to schools and coaching centres is a significant and fast-close opportunity — a school that licenses GyanSetu can offer every student personalised career guidance as part of their fee, something that currently only elite private schools can afford to provide individually. B2B contracts at even a fraction of India's 1.5 million schools represent enormous scale.

Curated referral partnerships with coaching platforms and certificate programs — when GyanSetu recommends a roadmap, it points students to the best resources. When a student converts to a paid coaching subscription through GyanSetu, the platform earns a referral fee. This is already how the market works informally; GyanSetu formalises and monetises it transparently.

How We Build This — The Product Roadmap

We're not trying to build everything at once. We're building the most valuable version first and expanding from there.

Phase 1 — The Core (Months 0–6)

- Career eligibility engine covering the 75 most-attempted national exams
- Path-switching calculator for the 20 most common career switch requests
- Personalised roadmap for NEET, JEE Mains, and UPSC Prelims — the three highest-volume exams
- NCERT AI tutor for Class 11 & 12 (PCB and PCM) — built on a curated RAG system
- PYQ bank for NEET, JEE, and UPSC — covering the last 10 years

Phase 2 — Depth and Breadth (Months 6–18)

- 100+ additional exams: Banking, SSC, Defense, State PCS, Teaching
- NCERT tutor expanded to all classes (6–12) and all subjects
- Income projection model with 7th Pay Commission integration and private sector salary data
- Roadmap builder for all 100+ exams
- Regional language interface — Hindi first, then Tamil, Telugu, Kannada

Phase 3 — Intelligence and Scale (Months 18–36)

- AI tutor trained on additional standard reference books (HC Verma, Lakhmir Singh, standard Law texts)
- Adaptive mock test engine with real-time difficulty calibration
- Parent dashboard with child progress reports and alerts
- Institutional B2B licensing platform for schools and coaching centres
- API for third-party integration (counsellors, coaching centres)

CLOSING — WHY THIS MATTERS

What We're Really Building

There's a phrase we keep coming back to in the team: equal opportunity is not equal access. Two students can theoretically have equal access to UPSC — same exam, same syllabus, open to everyone. But the student whose parents know an IAS officer gets mentorship, guidance, a realistic timeline, and moral support. The student from a small town gets a brochure.

GyanSetu is the mentor that the second student never had. The older sibling who sat them down and said: you can do this, here is exactly what it takes, here is the plan, here are the resources, here is what you'll earn at the end. And I'll be here to answer your questions at 11 PM when your textbook stops making sense.

We are not building another edtech app. We are trying to change the relationship that an entire generation of Indian students has with their own future. From anxiety to clarity. From confusion to confidence. From "I don't know what I'm doing" to "I have a plan."

> *"The question is not whether every student has a future. They do. The question is whether they get to see it clearly enough to walk toward it. GyanSetu exists to make the answer yes — for every student, in every town, from every background."*
>
> **— The GyanSetu Vision**

GyanSetu

Every student. Every path. Every possibility.